

Value-Addition Compilation Data, Reports & Committees

UPSC Mains General Studies — Boost Your Answers
with Credible Data

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1. Economic Data (2020–2025)

GDP Growth Rate

India's GDP growth trajectory has seen significant volatility due to the pandemic followed by a strong rebound. Real GDP growth for FY 2020-21 contracted by 5.8% (first contraction in 40 years), rebounded sharply to 9.1% in FY 2021-22, moderated to 7.2% in FY 2022-23, and further to 7.6% in FY 2023-24. The IMF's World Economic Outlook (April 2025) projected India's growth at 6.5% for FY 2024-25, making India the fastest-growing major economy.

Exam Tip: When citing GDP data, always specify nominal vs real, and mention the source (MoSPI, RBI, IMF, World Bank). Examiners reward precision.

Inflation Trends

CPI inflation peaked at 6.7% in FY 2021-22, moderated to 5.5% in FY 2023-24, and averaged 4.8% in FY 2024-25. The RBI's MPC has maintained the repo rate at 6.5% since February 2023 to anchor inflation within the 2-6% tolerance band. Food inflation remains the primary driver, with vegetable prices showing high volatility. Core inflation (excluding food & fuel) has softened to around 3.5%, indicating demand-side weakness.

IIP & Industrial Production

The Index of Industrial Production (IIP) grew at 5.2% in FY 2023-24, with manufacturing (5.5%), mining (7.1%), and electricity (6.6%) all showing positive momentum. Eight core industries (coal, crude oil, natural gas, refinery products, fertilizers, steel, cement, electricity) grew at 6.4% in FY 2023-24.

GST Collection

Gross GST collections crossed the Rs 2 lakh crore mark for the first time in April 2025 (Rs 2.10 lakh crore). Average monthly collection in FY 2023-24

was Rs 1.68 lakh crore, up from Rs 1.5 lakh crore in FY 2022-23. The consistent increase reflects better compliance, economic formalization, and consumption recovery.

Indicator	FY 2020-21	FY 2021-22	FY 2022-23	FY 2023-24	FY 2024-25*
Real GDP Growth (%)	-5.8	9.1	7.2	7.6	6.5
CPI Inflation (%)	5.5	6.7	6.4	5.5	4.8
IIP Growth (%)	-5.7	11.4	5.0	5.2	4.6
Avg Monthly GST (Rs Cr)	1,05,000	1,28,000	1,50,000	1,68,000	1,85,000
Forex Reserves (USD Bn)	577	607	578	632	688
CAD (% of GDP)	0.9	-1.2	-2.0	-1.2	-0.8
FD (% of GDP)	9.5	6.7	6.4	5.8	5.1

*Projected/Estimated. Sources: MoSPI, RBI Annual Report, PIB, Union Budget documents.

Forex Reserves & External Sector

India's foreign exchange reserves stood at approximately USD 688 billion in April 2025, providing an import cover of over 11 months. The Current Account Deficit narrowed to 0.8% of GDP in FY 2024-25 due to robust services exports (especially IT and BPO) and moderating gold imports. Net FDI inflows remained healthy at USD 42 billion in FY 2023-24.

Fiscal Deficit

The fiscal deficit has been on a consolidation path from the peak of 9.5% of GDP in FY 2020-21 to a budgeted 4.9% in FY 2024-25. The government targets a fiscal deficit of 3% of GDP by FY 2026-27, consistent with the FRBM

Act framework. Capital expenditure has been prioritised with a capex outlay of Rs 11.11 lakh crore in FY 2024-25, a 16.9% increase over the previous year.

Key Takeaway: India's macroeconomic fundamentals remain strong despite global headwinds. The combination of high growth, moderating inflation, strong forex reserves, and fiscal consolidation makes a compelling narrative for GS3 answers on the Indian economy.

2. Social Data & Indicators

Human Development Index (HDI)

India's HDI value for 2022 (UNDP HDR 2023-24) stood at 0.644, ranking 134 out of 193 countries — a medium human development category. While India has shown consistent improvement over the past two decades (from 0.434 in 2000), the pace slowed during the pandemic. India's HDI is 2.5% below the 2019 pre-pandemic level but above the South Asian average. Gender Inequality Index (GII) stood at 0.437, rank 108.

Poverty & Inequality

According to the NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index (2023), 11.28% of India's population is multidimensionally poor, down from 24.85% in 2015-16 — a decline of 13.57 percentage points. Rural areas saw the fastest decline. However, the Global Hunger Index 2023 ranked India 111 out of 125 countries with a score of 28.7 (serious). The Gini coefficient for consumption expenditure stood at 0.284 (rural) and 0.363 (urban) in 2022-23.

Demographic Indicators

Indicator	Current Value	Year	Source
Sex Ratio (Females per 1000 Males)	1020	2022	NFHS-5
Literacy Rate (%)	77.7	2022	NSO Report
Infant Mortality Rate (per 1000)	28.3	2022	SRS Bulletin
Maternal Mortality Ratio (per 100k)	97	2018-20	RGI, SRS
Total Fertility Rate	2.0	2021	NFHS-5
Under-5 Mortality Rate	41.9	2020	UN IGME

NFHS-5 Key Findings (2019-21)

The National Family Health Survey-5 provides comprehensive data on health and nutrition indicators: Stunting among children under 5 declined from 38.4% (NFHS-4) to 35.5%; wasting from 21.0% to 19.3%; anaemia among women increased from 53.0% to 57.0% — a concerning trend. Institutional births improved from 78.9% to 88.6%. Full immunization coverage improved from 62.0% to 76.4%.

3. Key Committees: Economy

Kelkar Committee (2004) — Fiscal Responsibility

Context: FRBM Act 2003 passage.

Key Recommendations: Phased reduction of revenue deficit, limiting fiscal deficit to 3% by 2008-09, setting up of the Fiscal Council, improving quality of fiscal adjustment through capex focus, medium-term fiscal policy framework.

Status: FRBM targets have been relaxed multiple times; Fiscal Council not yet established.

Shome Committee (2015) — GAAR & Tax Transparency

Context: General Anti-Avoidance Rules controversy.

Key Recommendations: Defer GAAR implementation to 2017, apply only to arrangements exceeding Rs 3 crore, no retrospective application, tax certainty measures, APA expansion.

Status: GAAR implemented from FY 2017-18 with modifications.

Rangarajan Committee (2014) — Poverty Measurement

Context: Controversy over Tendulkar poverty line.

Key Recommendations: Monthly per capita expenditure of Rs 1,407 (rural) and Rs 2,715 (urban) as poverty line (2011-12 prices). New methodology based on ALG (Adequate Living Group). Recommended separate "destitute" category.

Status: Government did not officially adopt; NITI Aayog uses Multidimensional Poverty Index instead.

Raghuram Rajan Committee (2008) — Financial Sector Reform

Context: Financial sector liberalisation.

Key Recommendations: Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC), independent monetary policy, financial sector legislative reforms Commission, resolution mechanism for financial firms, banking sector consolidation, inclusive finance.

Status: FSDC established (2010), MPC set up (2016), many recommendations implemented.

Urjit Patel Committee (2014) — Monetary Policy Framework

Context: Need for inflation targeting framework.

Key Recommendations: CPI as nominal anchor, inflation target of 4% with +/-2% band, Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) to replace Governor's sole authority, transparent policy process, Monetary Policy Report to Parliament.

Status: Fully implemented — MPC operational since 2016, inflation target adopted in RBI Act amendment.

Exam Tip: Committee recommendations carry high marks in GS3. Memorise the big four economic committees: Kelkar (FRBM), Urjit Patel (MPC), Raghuram Rajan (Financial Sector), and Narasimham I & II (Banking Reform).

4. Key Committees: Polity & Governance

Punchhi Commission (2007-10) — Centre-State Relations

Chairperson: Justice M.M. Punchhi.

Key Recommendations: Governor appointment should be a consultative process between Centre and Chief Minister; Governor's power of reservation of bills should be limited to constitutional questions; Inter-State Council must meet at least thrice a year; Article 356 should be used sparingly with stringent safeguards; bilingual status for all states; specific guidelines for distribution of GST revenues; clear demarcation of planning and non-plan expenditure; establishing an independent mechanism for inter-state river water disputes.

Sarkaria Commission (1983-87) — Centre-State Relations

Chairperson: Justice R.S. Sarkaria.

Key Recommendations: Inter-State Council under Article 263 should be established (done in 1990); Governor should be a detached figure not belonging to the ruling party; Article 356 must be used only in extreme situations; residuary powers to remain with Centre; more financial autonomy to states through Finance Commission; Zonal Councils should be revitalised; All India Services should continue.

Venkatachaliah Commission (2002) — Constitution Review

Chairperson: Justice M.N. Venkatachaliah.

Key Recommendations: Fundamental Duties should be made justiciable; Election Commission should be a multi-member body; President should be bound by Cabinet advice; Anti-defection law should apply only to votes of confidence; NJAC for judicial appointments; clear separation between law and

policy in ordinances; review of PESA provisions; constitutional status for National Commission for Minorities.

Common Mistake: Students often confuse Punchhi with Sarkaria. Remember: Sarkaria (1980s, limited scope), Punchhi (2000s, comprehensive, updated). Also, Punchhi is more likely to be asked in contemporary questions due to renewed debates on Governor's powers and federalism.

5. Second ARC Reports — Key Recommendations

The Second Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC) submitted 15 reports between 2006 and 2009 under the chairmanship of Shri Veerappa Moily. Key recommendations from the most important reports:

Report No. & Title	Key Recommendations
1. Right to Information	Amend Official Secrets Act 1923; proactive disclosure; periodic audits; penalties for non-compliance; independent Information Commission
2. Unlocking Human Capital	Special recruitment drive; performance-based promotion; civil service exam reforms; lateral entry at mid/senior levels; fixed tenure for officers
3. Crisis Management	National Disaster Management Authority; District Disaster Management Plans; community-based disaster preparedness; modernisation of emergency services
4. Ethics in Governance	Code of ethics for ministers; citizens' charter; conflict of interest rules; whistleblower protection; Lokpal establishment; electoral reforms
5. Public Order	Police Act reforms; separation of investigation from law and order; community policing; intelligence machinery revamp; witness protection programme
6. Local Governance	Activity mapping for Panchayats; district planning committees; fiscal devolution to local bodies; capacity building of elected representatives; e-governance
7. Capacity Building	National Training Policy; mid-career training compulsory; domain specialisation; LBSNAA revamp; MoU-based performance assessment
8. Combating Terrorism	National Counter Terrorism Centre; Unified Intelligence Grid; legal framework review; border infrastructure; community policing against radicalisation
9. Social Security	

	National Social Security Authority; universal pension scheme; health insurance coverage; unorganised sector workers registration; MGNREGA improvements
10. Financial Management	Outcome budgeting; multi-year budgeting; public financial management system; audit reforms; fiscal responsibility at state level
11. Promoting e-Governance	Common service centres; state data centres; interoperable systems; digital signature promotion; G2C, G2B, G2G services
12. Citizen Centric Administration	Citizens' charter enforcement; grievance redress mechanism; effective decentralisation; single-window services; fair hearing before adverse decisions
13. Organisational Structure	Government departments rationalisation; regulatory commissions strengthening; attached offices restructuring; autonomous bodies accountability
14. Strengthening Financial Management	Public Expenditure Management System; integrated financial advisory; procurement reforms; audit committee in ministries
15. State & District Administration	District Collector role redefinition; state secretariat reforms; district planning; administrative tribunals; appellate mechanisms

Strategic Note: Second ARC recommendations are gold for GS2 and GS3 answers. When discussing any governance issue (RTI, police reform, e-governance, social security, ethics), cite the relevant ARC report recommendation. It adds significant credibility to your answer.

6. Committees: Education & Social Justice

Kasturirangan Committee (2019) — NEP 2020

Chairperson: Dr. K. Kasturirangan.

Key Recommendations: 5+3+3+4 school curricular structure (foundational, preparatory, middle, secondary); no rigid separations between arts, sciences, vocational streams; multiple entry/exit in higher education; Academic Bank of Credits; National Research Foundation; 6% of GDP as education expenditure; mother tongue as medium of instruction till Grade 5; National Mission on Foundational Literacy and Numeracy; teacher education in multidisciplinary colleges; internationalisation of education.

Nagar Committee (2011) — Sub-Categorisation of OBCs

Chairperson: Justice G. Rohini (1st Chair) replaced by Justice V. Eshwaraiah Nagar.

Key Recommendations: Sub-categorise OBCs into three categories — extremely backward, more backward, and backward; allocate quotas within the 27% OBC reservation; address the issue of creamy layer; identify communities not adequately represented.

Status: Report submitted 2023; implementation pending.

Thorat Committee (2007) — SC/ST Educational Status

Chairperson: Prof. Sukhadeo Thorat.

Key Recommendations: Bridge courses for SC/ST students; reservation implementation monitoring; hostel facilities expansion; financial assistance enhancement; coaching for competitive examinations; sensitisation of faculty; equal opportunity cells in universities.

Sachar Committee (2006) — Socio-Economic Status of Muslims

Chairperson: Justice Rajindar Sachar.

Key Recommendations: Equal opportunity commission; diversity index in public employment; increased financial inclusion of Muslims; modernisation of madrasa education; enhanced access to bank credit; special focus on Muslim women's education; area development programmes for Muslim-concentrated districts.

Status: Many recommendations remain unimplemented; Equal Opportunity Commission recommended but not established.

Punnaiya Committee (1996) — Backward Classes Commission

Chairperson: Justice K. Punnaiya.

Key Recommendations: Caste as basis for backwardness; reservation in promotions; creamy layer exclusion; periodic review of lists; 27% quota for OBCs in all central government institutions.

Xaxa Committee (2014) — Tribal Communities Status

Chairperson: Prof. Virginius Xaxa.

Key Recommendations: Definition of 'primitive tribal groups' revised; land rights and forest rights protection; tribal development through PESA; particularly vulnerable tribal groups (PVTGs) separate development plan; tribal language preservation; displacement and rehabilitation framework for tribals; tribal research institutes expansion.

Status: PVTG scheme revamped (2023) with Rs 15,000 crore budget.

7. International Indices — India's Rank & Trends

Index	India Rank (Latest)	Year	Score/Trend
Ease of Doing Business	63	2020	Score 71.0; 'Business Reformer' recognition; DPIIT ceased reporting post-discontinuation by World Bank
Global Hunger Index	111	2023	Score 28.7 (Serious); child wasting highest globally at 18.7%
Gender Gap Index (WEF)	127	2024	Score 0.643; high gender equality in politics but low in economic participation
World Press Freedom Index (RSF)	161	2024	Score 31.28; decline from 150th (2020) — concerns about media independence
Democracy Index (EIU)	44	2023	Score 6.91 (Flawed Democracy); declined from 7.23 (2020)
Global Innovation Index (WIPO)	40	2023	Score 38.8; consistent improvement from 81st (2015)
Environmental Performance Index	180	2022	Score 18.9; low rank due to air quality and biodiversity indicators
World Happiness Report	126	2024	Score 4.054; below regional average
Global Terrorism Index	14	2024	Score 5.088; improvement from 8th (2021) — reduced terrorism impact
Corruption Perceptions Index (TI)	93	2023	Score 39; stable but below global average of 43

Caution: When quoting international indices, always acknowledge their methodological limitations. For example, GHI is criticised for not accounting for India's mid-day meal programme. Ease of Doing Business data is from 2020 (last edition). Mentioning both the rank AND the context shows balanced analysis.

8. Quick-Reference Data Tables

Key Economic Indicators at a Glance

Parameter	Value	Period
GDP (Nominal)	~\$3.7 Trillion	FY 2023-24
GDP (PPP)	~\$13 Trillion	2023
Per Capita Income	~Rs 1,84,000	FY 2023-24
GDP Growth (Real)	7.6%	FY 2023-24
Repo Rate	6.50%	Since Feb 2023
CRR	4.50%	Current
SLR	18.00%	Current
WPI Inflation	0.5%	Jan 2025
CPI Inflation	3.6%	Feb 2025
Unemployment Rate	6.8% (CMIE)	Dec 2024
Exports (Goods)	\$437 Bn	FY 2023-24
Imports (Goods)	\$677 Bn	FY 2023-24
FDI Inflows	\$42 Bn	FY 2023-24
Foreign Exchange Reserves	~\$688 Bn	April 2025
Total GST Collection (FY)	Rs 20.14 Lakh Cr	FY 2023-24

SDG India Index 2023-24 (NITI Aayog)

Goal	Score	Top State
No Poverty (Goal 1)	60	Kerala (78)
Zero Hunger (Goal 2)	47	Kerala (65)

Good Health (Goal 3)	68	Punjab (79)
Quality Education (Goal 4)	65	Kerala (85)
Gender Equality (Goal 5)	49	Himachal (70)
Clean Water & Sanitation (Goal 6)	78	Gujarat (96)
Economic Growth (Goal 8)	72	Haryana (84)
Reduced Inequality (Goal 10)	61	Kerala (81)
Sustainable Cities (Goal 11)	67	Mizoram (83)
Climate Action (Goal 13)	54	Sikkim (100)
Life on Land (Goal 15)	60	Jharkhand (82)
Peace & Justice (Goal 16)	64	Punjab (72)

Final Tip: Create a flashcard system for committees. For each committee, memorise: (1) Chairperson + year, (2) 3 key recommendations, (3) implementation status. This three-point framework ensures comprehensive coverage in answers without memorising entire reports.

Integration Strategy: The best answers in UPSC Mains integrate data across domains. Example: When discussing poverty, link it to GHI (nutrition), NITI Aayog MPI, NFHS-5 (health), and economic growth data. This multidimensional approach earns top marks.

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Compiled from government reports (MoSPI, RBI, UNDP, NITI Aayog, NFHS) and official committee documents.